



NITI Aayog



SECTOR AT A GLANCE 02

Early Childhood Education and Care in India

DRAFT

SECTOR AT A GLANCE 02

EARLY CHILDHOOD CARE AND EDUCATION IN INDIA

EDUCATION IN INDIA

The '**Sector-at-a-Glance**' provides an easy-to-read overview and basic understanding of a sector, sub-sector, or thematic area. The facts and insights on the sector are supported by relevant data and best practices from credible government and multilateral sources. The document covers the structure, key trends, opportunities and challenges, government initiatives, and the way forward for the sector.

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Overview

Early childhood is the period from birth to eight years of age. In the new school structure proposed under the National Education Policy (NEP), 5+3+3+4, the foundational stage covers the first five years (ages 3 to 8).¹ Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) assumes paramount importance in fostering essential physical, motor, cognitive, and socio-emotional abilities in children and laying the early groundwork for foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN) skills.² India has taken significant strides toward improving ECCE services. Surveys from UNICEF revealed that nearly 8 out of 10 children in the age group of 3 to 6 years are enrolled in some form of ECCE program, reflecting the success of India's efforts to expand access to early childhood education.³

Focus on improving ECCE in India by strengthening infrastructure in Anganwadi Centres (AWCs), enhancing the professional development of ECCE staff and engaging parents and communities. This can lead to greater socio-emotional and cognitive development for children.

However, challenges like over-emphasis on traditional learning formats, nutrition-related challenges, and limited ECCE teacher capacity require continued attention.

Given these opportunities and challenges, the major policy area of focus include curriculum and pedagogy, ECCE teacher recruitment, training and development of teachers and staff, child health and nutrition, parent and community engagement, equity and inclusion, resourcing, governance, and assessment of ECCE, and financing of ECCE. Several ongoing and recent central government initiatives, including but not limited to National ECCE Policy and Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0, focus on higher quality of ECCE in India. These efforts, along with several state-level and local-level policies and initiatives, seek to ensure that every child can obtain age-appropriate development and care through quality ECCE initiatives.

Going forward, relevant stakeholders like Ministry of Education can focus on enabling states to adopt flexible curricular and pedagogical approaches that meet the unique needs of all students and driving coordination between education and child development departments, effectively monitoring and standardising teacher quality, and enabling parents and caregivers to play an effective role in ECCE.

Figure 1: Key ECCE statistics

1.39 MN
Anganwadi centres in India

30.3 MN
Children (aged 3-6 years) with access to
ECCE through AWCs

68%
Share of teachers with formal pre-
primary level training

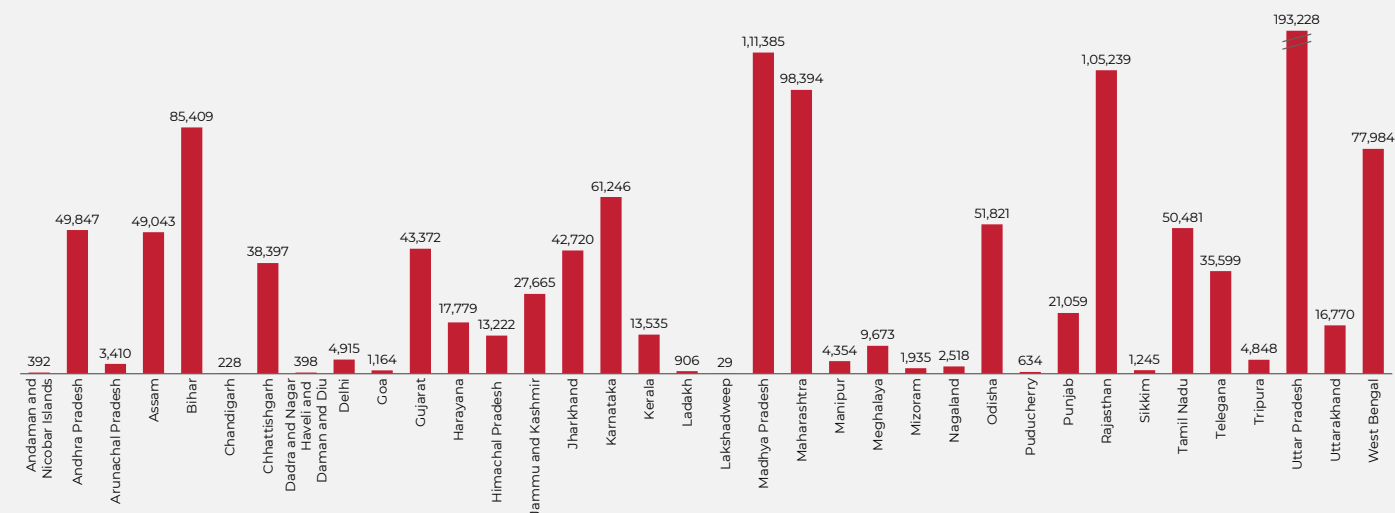
Source: AWCs- Ministry of Women and Child Development, Poshan Bhi Padhai Bhi, 2023; Children accessing ECCE- Ministry of Women and Child Development, Amount allocated for ECCE under Poshan 2.0, 2022; Teacher with training- Ministry of Education, Report on UDISE+, 2021-22

1 Ministry of Education, , National Education Policy , 2020

2 Ministry of Education, , National Education Policy , 2020

3 UNICEF, Early childhood education: For school readiness and to build a foundation for lifelong learning, accessed August 2023

Figure 2: Number of primary schools having Anganwadi/ECE centres of pre-primary sections by state and UT (2021-22)



Source: Ministry of Education, UDISE+ 2021-22, 2022

Key trends

This section dives deeper into India's ECCE landscape, outlining statistics and trends on:

1. Curriculum and pedagogy
2. ECCE teacher recruitment, training, and development
3. Child health and nutrition
4. Parent and community engagement
5. Equity and inclusion
6. Resourcing, governance, and assessment of ECCE
7. Financing of ECCE

Curriculum and pedagogy

Curriculum and pedagogy in ECCE includes diverse activities and teaching methodologies tailored to foster holistic development, including cognitive, social, emotional, and physical skills in young learners.

Recent policy focus has been on revising curricular structure:

The previous academic structure did not cover children in the age group of 3-6 years.⁴ The Foundational Stage introduced by the National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage (NCF) under NEP 2020 emphasises an integrated approach to ECCE for children between the ages of 3-8.⁵ The Foundational Stage begins at Age 3 and ends at Age 8 i.e., five years of schooling from preschool to Grade 2.⁶

Enhancing ECCE curricula is a key policy priority:

The National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage has been formulated in alignment with the vision of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, and to enable its effective implementation. The framework guides states to devise context-specific approaches to curriculum development.⁷

⁴ Ministry of Education, National Education Policy, 2020

⁵ Ministry of Education, National Education Policy, 2020

⁶ Ministry of Education, National Education Policy, 2020

⁷ NCERT, National Curriculum Framework for Foundational Stage, 2022

ECCE teacher recruitment, training, and development

ECCE teacher recruitment, training, and development includes comprehensive programs to attract skilled educators, provision of specialized training, and continuous enhancement of teaching methodologies.

There are limited avenues for training of preschool teachers:

Anganwadi training centres (AWTCs) exist across the country to train India's nearly 1.4 million Anganwadi workers and /teachers. Approximately 1200 AWTCs are required to train all Anganwadi workers, but only 500 AWTCs were operational as per a 2014 report.⁸ Further, the number of AWTCs varies across states with states like Mizoram, Sikkim, Goa has 1 each and states/UTs like Tamil Nadu, Chandigarh, Lakshadweep do not have any AWTCs leading to difficulty in accessing training facilities.⁹ Further, 1% of private teacher education institutions offer programmes for preschool teachers.¹⁰

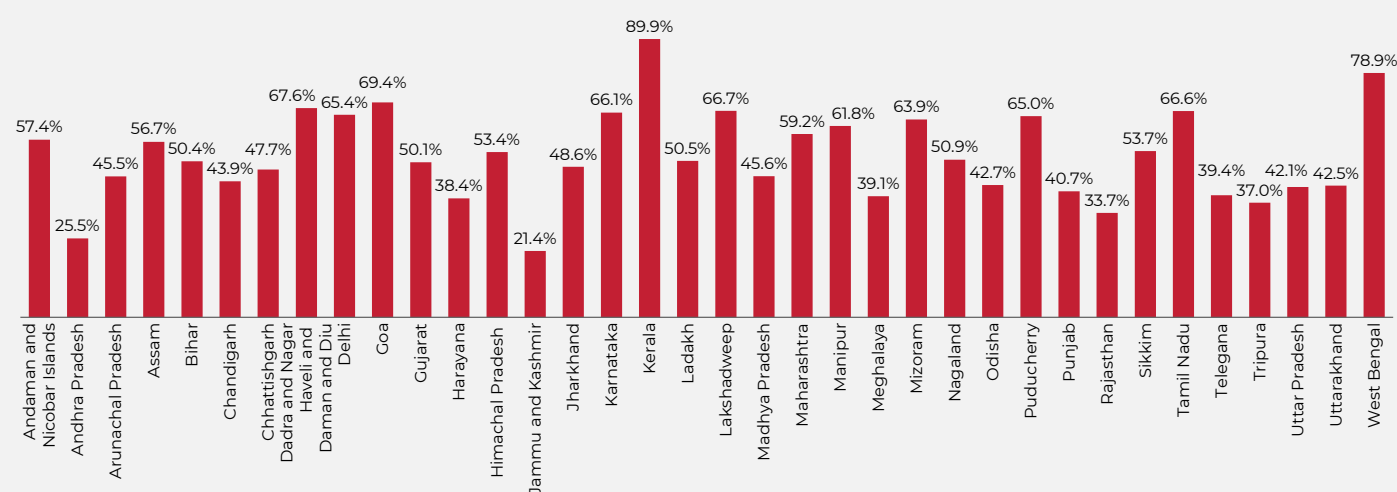
There is a significant disparity among states in the percentage of qualified teachers:

The share of trained teachers at pre-primary levels ranges from 89.9% to 21.4% across states.¹¹

Capacity building of ECCE teachers emerges as a key national priority:

One of India's key priorities is to develop a high cadre a proficient ECCE teachers. To achieve this, existing Anganwadi workers/teachers will undergo systematic training following the curricular and pedagogical framework designed by NCERT. Anganwadi workers/teachers possessing 10+2 qualifications or higher will enrol in a 6-month certificate program in ECCE. Meanwhile, those with lower educational qualifications will participate in a one-year diploma program that encompasses early literacy, numeracy, and other pertinent facets of ECCE.

Figure 3: Percentage of trained teachers at pre-primary level (2021-22)



Source: Ministry of Education, UDISE+ 2021-22, 2022

Child health and nutrition

Child health and nutrition in ECCE includes access to nutritious meals, healthcare interventions, and awareness campaigns, fostering the overall well-being and development of young children.

Malnutrition in children under five has declined in the last two decades:

⁸ World Bank, Early Childhood Education in India: A Suggestive Roadmap, 2014

⁹ Ministry of Women and Child Development, Anganwadi Workers Training Centres, 2013

¹⁰ National Steering Committee for National Curriculum Frameworks, NCF for Foundational Stage, 2022

¹¹ Ministry of Education, Report on UDISE+, 2021-22

The percentage of stunted children has reduced from 44.9% in 2005-06 to 35.5% in 2019-21. Similarly, the number of wasted children has fallen from 22.9% in 2005-06 to 19.3% in 2021-22.¹²

Improving nutrition intake among children is a key national priority:

Recently, India has bolstered its focus on child nutrition with POSHAN 2.0, focusing on diet diversity, food fortification, and nutrition awareness campaigns. Additionally, new state-level initiatives are promoting locally sourced, nutritious foods to further address malnutrition among children.¹³

Parent and community engagement

Parent and community engagement in ECCE includes encouraging active participation, providing support networks, and fostering partnerships between educators, families, and local communities, creating enriching environments for children's holistic development.

Parental awareness on ECCE importance and benefits remains low:

Despite the policy efforts, low-income parents lack awareness on benefits of pre-school education and thus do not send their children to pre-schools. Lack of understanding of developmentally appropriate ECCE program among parents contributes to poor learning outcomes and nutrition for children.¹⁴

Parental involvement emerges as a priority in improving ECCE outcomes:

Recently released curriculum frameworks such as the National Curriculum Framework for Foundational Stage and National ECCE Curriculum Framework acknowledge that during the early stages of education, it becomes increasingly crucial for parents to provide a nurturing, conducive and supportive environment for optimal development and learning of their children across all dimensions - physical, cognitive, and socio-emotional.¹⁵ Engaging parents also acts as a catalyst in improving learning outcomes and school readiness levels.

Equity and inclusion

Equity and inclusion in ECCE includes ensuring access to quality education for all children, regardless of background or ability, by implementing inclusive policies, providing resources, and creating supportive environments that celebrate diversity and cater to individual needs.

Low preschool attendance across social groups:

In 2019-20, preschool attendance rates were recorded at 44% in urban areas and 39% in rural areas.¹⁶ Collectively, 40% of children between the ages of 2 and 4 were reported to be attending preschool.¹⁷ Notably, attendance was found to be lowest among children belonging to Socially and Economically Disadvantaged Groups (SEDGs).¹⁸

Recent policy efforts are directed towards inclusive curriculum and practices at ECCE centres:

Existing policy efforts like Samagra Shiksha Abhiyaan, National ECCE policy recognize and address the diverse needs, backgrounds, and circumstances of all children, including children with special needs, to ensure equal access to quality education and promote positive outcomes.

¹² International Institute for Population Sciences, National Family Health Survey (NFHS) 3, 2005-06; International Institute for Population Sciences, National Family Health Survey (NFHS) 5, 2019-20

¹³ Ministry of Women and Child Development, POSHAN Abhiyaan, 2023

¹⁴ NIOS, Involvement of parents and community

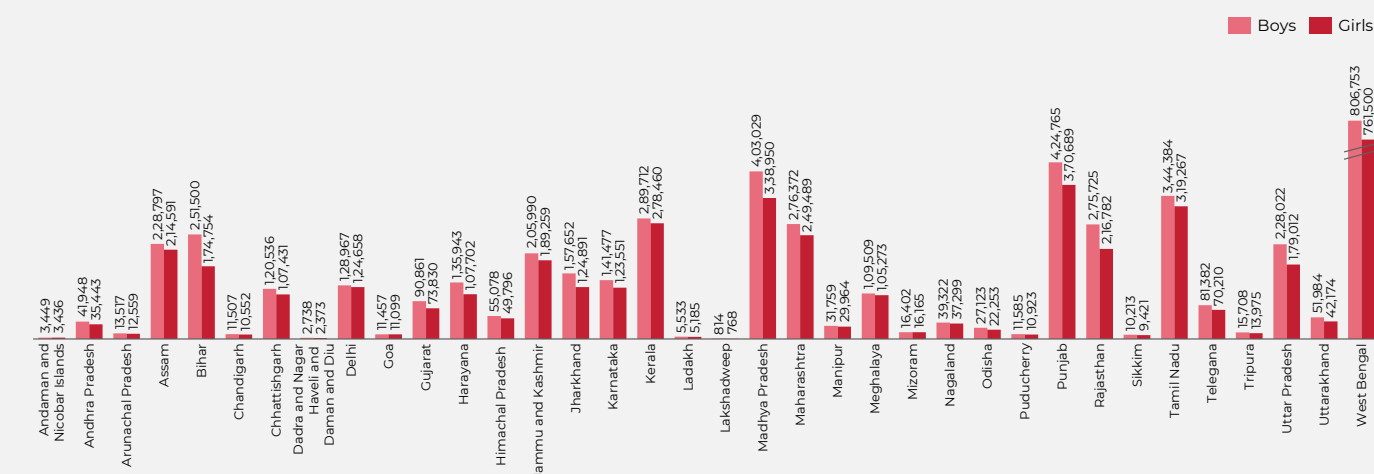
¹⁵ NCERT, National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage, 2022; Ministry of Women and Child Development, National ECCE Curriculum Framework, 2022

¹⁶ NCERT, National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage, 2022

¹⁷ NCERT, National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage, 2022

¹⁸ NCERT, National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage, 2022

Figure 4: Number of boys and girls enrolled in pre-primary class by state and UT (2021-22)



Source: Ministry of Education, UDISE+ 2021-22, 2022

Note: This data does not cover pre-primary enrolment in ECCE centres of Anganwadi and private kindergartens as these are not a part of the UDISE+ system.

Resourcing, governance, and assessment of ECCE

Resourcing, governance, and assessment in ECCE include effective allocation of resources, sound governance structures, and continuous assessment mechanisms to ensure optimal utilization of these resources, alongside streamlined policies and regular evaluations.

AWCs are getting digitised:

99.5% of Anganwadis in India are using the ICDS-Rapid Reporting System (RRS) to digitally monitor physical infrastructure, available manpower and beneficiaries, and financial disbursements.¹⁹ In 2019, over 3,55,000 Anganwadi Workers were utilising the ICDS-CAS application across 21 States/UTs to identify underweight children through automated plotting of growth charts.²⁰ Additionally, in 2022, States/UTs procured a total of 11.03 lakh smartphones to equip 14 lakh Anganwadi Workers (AWWs) with advanced tools for improved service delivery and monitoring in various states²¹

Leveraging technology to enhance access and quality of ECCE and improve student learning assessment is a policy priority:

The NEP proposes the establishment of a national repository comprising high-quality resources aimed at foundational literacy and numeracy. This repository will be hosted on the Digital Infrastructure for Knowledge Sharing (DIKSHA) platform. Furthermore, the policy aims to introduce and assess technological solutions designed to assist teachers in overcoming language barriers between educators and students. These solutions are also aimed to facilitate accurate customised test assessments, thereby promoting adaptive pedagogy.²²

Financing of ECCE

Financing for ECCE includes strategic investment and sustainable funding models aimed at expanding access, improving infrastructure, and ensuring quality programs, fostering an environment where every child has equitable access to high-quality early childhood education and care.

¹⁹ Ministry of Women and Child Development, Digitization of Data Collected in Anganwadi Centres, 2019

²⁰ Ministry of Women and Child Development, Digitization of Data Collected in Anganwadi Centres, 2019

²¹ Ministry of Women and Child Development, Smartphone and Tablets to Anganwadi Workers, 2022

²² Ministry of Education, National Education Policy, 2020

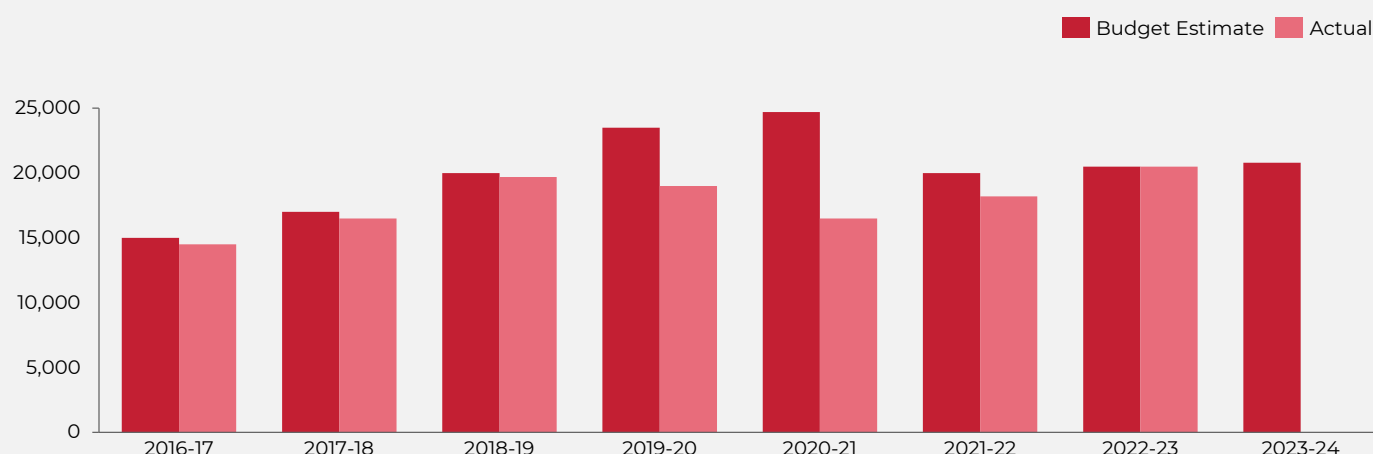
Existing financial allocation to ECCE in India is inadequate:

In 2019-20, the Central government allotted Rs. 19,927 crores to ICDS, with most of it going to honoraria, SNP, and salary, making up 87.4%. Only 7.5% went to infrastructure. Including the State share, the total budget was Rs. 33,171 crores. However, this falls short of expectations. Further, states struggle with utilising infrastructure and training funds effectively. Many rely on CSR and NGO partnerships to improve AWCs.²³

Increasing focus on funding for ECCE under Saksham Anganwadi:

The Pre-school Kit/ECCE sub-component of Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0 has been allocated INR 579.2 crore for a five-year period from 2021-22 to 2025-26.²⁴ These pre-school education learning kits are provided to Anganwadis to support children's development.²⁵

Figure 5: Actual and budget estimate allocations towards the Saksham Anganwadi and POSHAN 2.0 schemes in INR crore (2016-17–2023-24))



Source: PRS India, Demand for Grants 2023-24 Analysis : Women and Child Development, 2023

²³ NITI Aayog, Evaluation of ICDS Scheme of India, 2020

²⁴ Ministry of Women and Child Development, An amount of Rs. 579.20 crore allocated under ECCE/Pre-School Kit for five years period from 2021-22 to 2025-26 under Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0., 2022

²⁵ Ministry of Women and Child Development, An amount of Rs. 579.20 crore allocated under ECCE/Pre-School Kit for five years period from 2021-22 to 2025-26 under Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0., 2022

Opportunities and challenges

Opportunities

This section highlights the outcomes policymakers can achieve by adopting effective ECCE practices. These revolve primarily around well-trained ECCE teachers, high-quality ECCE institutions, greater involvement of key stakeholders like parents and higher equity.



Enhancement in training and professional development of ECCE staff:

Certification courses and diplomas tailored specifically for Anganwadi workers and ECCE teachers can be introduced to comprehensively cover early literacy, numeracy, and other pertinent aspects of ECCE. These educational initiatives can be implemented through a combination of offline and online methods, using platforms such as DTH channels and smartphones, to enable teachers to acquire ECCE qualifications without causing significant disruptions to their ongoing responsibilities.²⁶



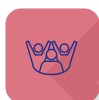
Better infrastructure in Anganwadi Centres (AWCs):

Anganwadi centres can be enhanced by constructing new infrastructure or improving existing facilities. This involves creating well-designed, child-friendly structures encompassing indoor and outdoor spaces, provisions for ample play materials, essential medical supplies, functional weighing machines, access to safe drinking water, properly functioning toilets, and effective handwashing amenities.²⁷



Increase in parental engagement:

Fostering the participation of parents and community members can be actively promoted to enhance the successful operation of ECCE programs.²⁸ Staff members at ECCE centres can develop an ongoing and productive relationship with parents by maintaining regular and positive communication. This includes sharing progress reports, arranging conferences, sending personalised notes, and keeping parents updated about upcoming events and activities.²⁹



Higher inclusivity in ECCE provision:

Inclusion and equal participation of children with disabilities in the ECCE ecosystem is a key national priority. Anganwadi centres lack essential infrastructure and assistive devices for children with disabilities, and AWCs are unable to conduct disability surveys necessary for the early diagnosis of disability in children.³⁰ Initiatives can be taken to create conducive environments for these children, such that teaching-learning processes are adaptive to their needs. Ministries overseeing education could work in collaboration with expert bodies like the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities.³¹

Challenges

This section highlights some of the major challenges and constraints facing ECCE in India. Efforts to resolve such challenges will ensure higher socio-emotional development of children, high quality ECCE staff and AWC facilities, improved health of children, and greater parent involvement.

²⁶ Ministry of Education, National Education Policy, 2020

²⁷ Ministry of Education, National Education Policy, 2020

²⁸ Ministry of Women and Child Development, National ECCE Policy, 2013

²⁹ NCERT, National Curriculum Framework for Foundational Stage, 2022

³⁰ UNESCO, State of the Education Report for India 2019 Children with Disabilities, 2019

³¹ Ministry of Education, National Education Policy, 2020



Excessive focus on traditional formats of learning:

The prevailing ECCE curriculum in most states prioritises academic subjects, overlooking important aspects of holistic development. In Anganwadis, play-based learning and socio-emotional development receive inadequate attention due to an unwavering focus on traditional 3Rs (reading, writing, and arithmetic).³² This lack of emphasis on play-based learning and social and emotional needs hampers children's ability to manage emotions, build relationships, and develop critical thinking and problem-solving skills, leading to low school readiness.³³



Insufficiency in training and qualification of ECCE teachers:

Many ECCE teachers are either unprepared or insufficiently trained due to outdated courses that lack practical hands on experience.³⁴ The current training programmes offered to ECCE teachers exhibit significant variation in duration, methodology, and exposure to theoretical concepts and practical application.³⁵ There is a paucity of induction programmes, continuous professional development, or ongoing support available for teachers.³⁶ As of 2021-22, 68% of teachers possessed formal training at the pre-primary school level in India.³⁷



High stunting rates for children in India:

The ECCE Task Force established by the MoWCD recognises the close links between nutrition and brain development. It notes that more than 35% of young children in India are stunted as per the latest NFHS data. Coordinated efforts to continue addressing early childhood nutrition in early years remain crucial to ensure that long-term developmental outcomes for children are not affected.³⁸



Constraints in infrastructure and effective resourcing of AWCs:

A government report submitted to the Parliament in July 2019 revealed that around 13% of Anganwadi centres still lacked access to drinking water facilities, and approximately 28% did not have proper sanitation facilities.³⁹



Shortage of time with Anganwadi workers for education-related interventions:

Anganwadi workers are tasked with diverse responsibilities, including preschool education, house visits, surveys, record-keeping, providing supplementary food to children, and offering health education to women. However, a study conducted in a South Indian city revealed that two-thirds of Anganwadi workers feel overwhelmed and stressed due to their workload, surpassing the expectations outlined in the ICDS project. Furthermore, these workers find themselves strained by additional responsibilities outside the ICDS scope, such as participating in health awareness campaigns, conducting surveys, and fulfilling election duties sparing insufficient time for activities like preschool education.⁴⁰

³² Ministry of Women and Child Development, National ECCE Curriculum Framework, 2022

³³ NCERT, National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage, 2022

³⁴ Ministry of Women and Child Development, National ECCE Curriculum Framework, 2022

³⁵ Ministry of Women and Child Development, National ECCE Curriculum Framework, 2022

³⁶ Ministry of Women and Child Development, National ECCE Curriculum Framework, 2022

³⁷ Ministry of Education, Report on UDISE+, 2021-22

³⁸ NIPCCD, Report of the Task Force on Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE), 2022

³⁹ Ministry of Women and Child Development, Modernisation Programme for Anganwadi Centres, 2019

⁴⁰ Tripathy, Monica; Kamath, Sowmini P.; Baliga, B. Shantharam; Jain, Animesh1. Perceived responsibilities and operational difficulties of anganwadi workers at a coastal south Indian city. Medical Journal of Dr. D.Y. Patil University 7(4):p 468-472, Jul-Aug 2014. | DOI: 10.4103/0975-2870.135270

Institutional framework and policy landscape –

Key ministries and departments

This section highlights the major central government bodies and national-level institutions that oversee ECCE.



Ministry of Education

The Ministry of Education ensures the implementation of the National Policy on Education in letter and spirit. It functions through two key departments- the Department of School Education & Literacy is relevant for ECCE here. The Department aims for “universalisation of education” and making better citizens out of young children. The Department is involved in the implementation of the PM Poshan scheme, creates guidelines and frameworks like the National Curriculum Framework for Foundational Learning, sets educational standards, promotes inclusive and quality education for all, works on teacher development, educational infrastructure, and educational research and innovation.⁴¹



Ministry of Women and Child Development

Promotes policies and programs that support the establishment and strengthening of early childhood care and education centres, such as Anganwadis, which provide early learning experiences, nutrition, health, and protection to children. It also emphasizes the importance of early stimulation, early literacy, and school readiness by drafting policies and guidelines on early childhood care and education.

A noteworthy body under the aegis of the Ministry is the **National Institute of Public Cooperation and Child Development (NIPCCD)** which supports the MoWCD with programmatic research, capacity building and advisory for important schemes and in areas of children's holistic development, mental health and protection for ECCE.⁴²

Major policies and programs

This section highlights existing policies related to ECCE and their most prominent features. A more comprehensive list of policies is provided in the policy repository of the NITI Knowledge Platform.



National Education Policy, 2020⁴³

The National Education Policy has outlined multiple initiatives aims to ensure the provision of universal and high-quality ECCE for all children between the ages of 3-6 years before 2030.

The policy proposes various reforms in ECCE to ensure that all children are school ready prior to entering Grade 1:

- As part of a new 5+3+3+4 curricular and pedagogical structure, developing a new National Curricular and Pedagogical Framework for Early Childhood Care and Education (with sub-frameworks for 0-3-year-olds and 3-8-year-olds) to provide holistic child development, and ensuring that all children move to a preparatory or Balvatika class prior to the age of 5 and Grade 1
- Expanding and strengthening India's ECCE institutions with adequate child-friendly infrastructure and trained Anganwadi workers and teachers, including introducing ECCE in a phased manner for Ashramshalas in predominantly tribal areas

⁴¹ Ministry of Education, About, accessed December 2023

⁴² MoWCD, National Institute of Public Cooperation and Child Development, accessed December 2023

⁴³ Ministry of Education, National Education Policy, 2020

- Developing a cadre of high-quality ECCE teachers through a systematic training effort for all Anganwadi teachers through an NCERT-aligned curricular framework, followed by state-specific efforts in the long term to develop qualified ECCE educators



National ECCE Policy⁴⁴

The Policy seeks to universalize access to ECCE by providing comprehensive childcare support, infrastructure, and services designed to nurture the overall well-being and developmental needs of children. It aims to raise awareness and foster a common understanding about the significance of ECCE, while also promoting strong collaborations with communities and families to improve the quality of life for young children. Additionally, the policy mandates the provision of safe, child-friendly, and developmentally appropriate play and learning materials.



Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0⁴⁵

The scheme aims to address nutrition related deficiencies and malnutrition among children up to the age of 6 years and promote nutrition awareness and good eating habits for sustainable health and wellbeing.

⁴⁴ Ministry of Women and Child Development, National ECCE Policy, 2013
⁴⁵ Ministry of Women and Child Development, Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0, 2021

Way forward

The NEP envisions the holistic development of young learners as crucial for developing school readiness and for achieving success in the educational system and lifelong well-being. The policies, programs, and frameworks set into motion by the NEP emphasize these objectives by ensuring that curricular and pedagogical approaches are multifaceted, play-based, and flexible, and establishing standards for teacher quality and infrastructure at Anganwadi centres to promote effective learning environments.

Some ideas to enable and sustain policy progress across these fronts, based on proposals from institutions like the Ministry of Women and Child Development, the NITI Aayog, and UNICEF include:

 Increase emphasis on age age-appropriate learning	Inculcate flexibility in adoption of guiding ECCE frameworks⁴⁶ - Facilitate tailored adoption of ECCE-related national-level curriculum frameworks as per state-specific needs – including an emphasis on play based learning and contextualisation to varied multilingual and multicultural classrooms, alongside child's unique needs (including the development of a gender-sensitive curriculum and bias-mitigation efforts for parents and caregivers, as well as supporting children with special needs with adaptations to their physical environment, the presence of trained educators, and appropriate learning materials) - Aid development of localised model playbooks and teaching materials, and provide states with resource teams for technical support in contextualising the curriculum	Maintain continuum of learning across the foundational stage⁴⁷ - Ensure that ECCE-related curriculum and pedagogical practices follow a continuum till higher grades, as guided by the NCF for Foundational Stage- e.g. more play-based learning in grades 1-2 - Enable greater coordination between relevant departments and institutions- e.g. committees/divisions for collaborative action between officials from Department of Women and Child Development and Department of Education
 Strengthen training and qualification systems for ECCE teachers	Standardise and ensure continuity in ECCE teacher education⁴⁸ - Ensure state-specific standardisation of ECCE teacher training programs across different provisioning channels, in line with the emphasis on standardisation by the National ECCE Curriculum Framework - Ensure regular training by cluster-level mentors, and using innovative	Improve incentive and monitoring systems⁴⁹ - Provide incentives like awards to high-performing Anganwadi workers/ECCE teachers, minimum wage assurance and promotion opportunities - Leverage online MIS systems, including the ones existing in K12 schools, for systematic monitoring and supervision of training sessions

⁴⁶ Ministry of Women and Child Development, National ECCE Curriculum Framework, 2022; Ministry of Education, Implementation plan for NEP, 2020; Department of Women & Child Development and Social Welfare, West Bengal, Shishu Alloy, accessed on 2023

⁴⁷ NCERT, National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage, 2022

⁴⁸ Ministry of Women and Child Development, National ECCE Curriculum Framework, 2022; Ministry of Education, National Education Policy, 2020

⁴⁹ NITI Aayog, Convergent Anganwadi Management, Kerala, 2020

	means like peer learning models through a mix of online/offline channels • Inculcate ECCE programs in existing Teacher Education Institutions (TEIs)	
 Increase parental and community participation in ECCE education	Boost community involvement in ECCE through Anganwadi workers/helpers⁵⁰ • Enable Anganwadi workers/helpers to organising community-based events by providing training and material support • Facilitate local decision-making to develop community centres for child play and early learning as guided by the NCF for Foundational Stage • Create incentive structures for Anganwadi workers to proactively seek community participation in child development activities	Increase parent inclusion in early childhood education programmes⁵¹ • Raise awareness on the importance of early childhood education and nutrition through campaigns and parent education programs, in line with the emphasis on parental involvement in ECCE by the NCF for Foundational Stage • Establish continuous engagement channels with parents to assess their child's progress online and offline

⁵⁰ UNICEF, Evaluation of Community Management of Acute Malnutrition (CMAM): Global Synthesis Report, 2021

⁵¹ NCERT, National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage, 2022; UNICEF, Early childhood education, accessed June 2023; Ministry of Women and Child Development, National ECCE Policy, 2013

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